

Instructor: Date:

Learner: Regional Branch:

Program: Center:

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Let's Start!

Let's learn about baseball, America's national pastime!



Learning Outcome

Describe detailed facts about events or actions in work and social contexts, in written or spoken situations.

Can Do Statements

- I can talk about leisure time, culture and sports.
- I can describe people, events or things.
- I can report facts about events and actions.

Ask your partner:

- How would you describe baseball?
- Do you consider baseball an exciting game? Why? Why not?

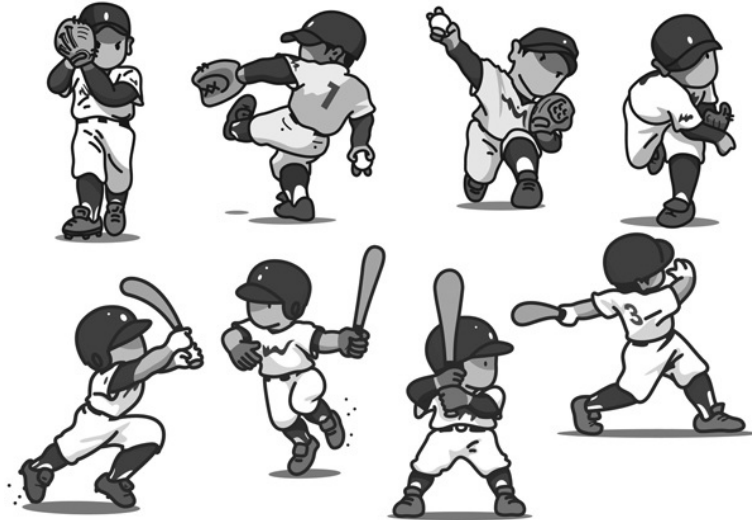




Let's Explore!

The **boys of summer***

* *"The Boys of Summer"* is the title of a famous book about baseball. Baseball is traditionally played in the summer months.



Instructions: Read the text aloud.

Today, baseball is one of the most captivating symbols in North American culture. Professional baseball games are viewed live and on TV by millions of people of different backgrounds and ages. Viewership for the final game of the 1986 championship was reported to have exceeded forty million. There are "little leagues" for children and "beer leagues" for amateur adults in almost every town. Foreigners are always surprised to find that in the United States some baseball sluggers are more recognizable than politicians. A baseball-like game was said to have been played by North American children in the early 1800s, and the first game was claimed to have been recorded by Abner Doubleday in Cooperstown, New York. This myth has also been debunked, and it was eventually discovered that the first game was actually played in Beachville. In the beginning the rules were more of a confused collection of guidelines, with surprising inconsistencies in the number of bases, outs, and innings. The rules were said to have been standardized by Alexander Cartwright in 1845, and soon after, a number of baseball clubs were formed. Games were played in cities around the country and the baseball fan was born. People began to follow their favorite players and teams. The viewing public was captivated by players such as Babe Ruth, who was said to have been able to hit a ball over 600 feet. It is not difficult to understand the popularity of baseball. There is a small amount of equipment needed and the rules are not confusing. It is a sport that can be played by almost everyone. It's not just America's pastime anymore, either. Baseball is enjoyed in dozens of countries, from Japan to the Dominican Republic.





Let's Practice!

Tom and Mike share some facts about sports.

Instructions: Choose the right words from the word bank to complete the sentences. There are two words that you don't need to use.

Word Bank

- was said • wasn't said • was claimed to • were said to • was reported
- were reporting • were reported

1. A baseball-like game _____ to have been played.
2. The first televised game _____ have been watched by millions of viewers.
3. The rules _____ to have been standardized.
4. The public was captivated by players who _____ have been able to hit a ball over 600 feet.
5. For the final game of the 1986 championship, viewership _____ to have exceeded forty million.



Let's Practice!

Tom and Mike discuss their favorite sports.

Instructions: Read the following statements aloud. Check your pronunciation with your instructor.

1. In the beginning the rules were more of a confused collection of guidelines, with surprising inconsistencies in the number of bases, outs, and innings.
2. Professional baseball games are viewed live and on TV by millions of people of different backgrounds and ages.
3. Foreigners are always surprised to find that in the United States some baseball sluggers are more recognizable than politicians.
4. Viewership for the final game of the 1986 championship was reported to have exceeded forty million.
5. There are "little leagues" for children and "beer leagues" for amateur adults in almost every town.





Extension Activity

A picture dictionary.

Instructions: Complete the following steps. Fill in the Self-Assessment.

- On a blank piece of paper, draw a picture of a baseball diamond.
- Go online to find the names of each position and each location (e.g. pitcher's mound, left field).
- Label each position on your diagram and write a short definition.
- Show your picture dictionary to a partner and explain each word.

Self-Assessment

Yes

No

I research baseball vocabulary.

☐
☐

I define the words used to talk about baseball.

☐
☐

I present information in a visual dictionary.

☐
☐

I share information with a partner.

☐
☐


Target Words

- to view** (verb): to watch
e.g. Professional baseball games are viewed live and on TV by millions of people of different backgrounds and ages.
- viewership** (noun): the total number of people who watch something, usually on TV
e.g. Viewership for the final game of the 1986 championship was reported to have exceeded forty million.
- slugger** (noun): baseball player who hits the ball with power
e.g. In the United States some baseball sluggers are more recognizable than politicians.
- pastime** (noun): hobby; activity done for enjoyment
e.g. Baseball is not just America's pastime anymore, either.
- base** (noun): a small, square cushion that a player must touch in order to score run
e.g. In the beginning the rules were more of a confused collection of guidelines, with surprising inconsistencies in the number of bases, outs, and innings.
- out** (noun): player who has been retired by the opposing team
e.g. The team needed just three outs to end the game.





Learning Points

Describing the Effects of Something

You use adjectives to describe the effects of something on a person.

Adjectives ending in **-ing** show the effect that something has on a person.

Adjectives ending in **-ed** show how the person has been affected by the situation or thing.

Adjectives ending in **-ed** can only be used to describe feelings or emotions. They describe how a person feels. They cannot be used to describe an object or situation.

Adjectives ending in **-ing** can be used either with a person or a situation. They describe the characteristics of a person or a situation. They also describe how a situation makes you feel.

Compare the differences:

- John is bored. (John feels bored.)
- John is boring. (John is a boring person.)
- The movie is boring. (The movie causes people to feel bored.)

You cannot say *the movie is bored*, since the subject is not a person.

Example:

- I was **excited** by how **exciting** the baseball game was yesterday.
- John was **bored** by the **boring** race he saw last night.
- That football game was **tiring**. I felt really **tired** last night.

Examples:

- Today baseball is one of the most captivating symbols of North American culture.
- The viewing public was captivated by players such as Babe Ruth.





Learning Points

Simple Past Passive to Report Events

You use the active voice when you want the 'doer' of the action to be the subject.
You use the passive voice when you want the 'receiver' of the action to be the subject.

You can use the passive voice when you want to report events that happened in the past in a general way.

Most of spoken English uses active speech. When you use an active sentence to report an event, the subject is the focus of the sentence.

Example:

- *Newspapers reported that 40 million Americans (subject) **watched** the final game in 1986 (object).*

A passive sentence puts the emphasis on the object of the active sentence. When you use a passive sentence to report an event, the object of the active sentence now becomes the subject and focus of the passive sentence.

Example:

- *The final game in 1986 (subject) **was reported to have been watched by** 40 million Americans (object).*

You make the passive form of a verb by using tenses of the *be* verb followed by the past participle.

You use the structure:

subject + Simple Past passive reporting verb + To-Infinitive (Perfect or Perfect Continuous tense)

For example:

- *A baseball-like game **was said to have been played by** North American children in the 1800s.*
- *Babe Ruth **was said to have been able to hit** a ball over 600 feet.*

Examples:

- *The first game was claimed to have been recorded by Abner Doubleday in Cooperstown, New York.*
- *The rules were said to have been standardized by Alexander Cartwright in 1845.*

